

Question:

An automobile battery produces a potential difference (or "voltage") of 12 volts between its terminals. (It really consists of six 2 volt batteries following one after the other.) A headlightbulb is to be connected directly across the terminals of the battery and dissipate 40 watts of joule heat. What current will it draw and what must its resistance be?

Answer Choices:

- A. 3.0 amps, 4 ohms
- B. 2.8 amps, 3.2 ohms
- C. 3.75 amps, 3.2 ohms
- D. 4 amps, 3 ohms
- E. 3.33 amps, 3.6 ohms
- F. 5 amps, 2.4 ohms
- G. 4.5 amps, 2.67 ohms
- H. 2.2 amps, 5.45 ohms
- I. 2.5 amps, 4.8 ohms
- J. 3.5 amps, 4 ohms

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

The power dissipated by the head light bulb is given by $P = I^2 R$, where I is the current and R is the resistance. Rearranging the equation to solve for current, we get $I = \sqrt{P/R}$. Given that $P = 40$ watts and $R = 3.2$ ohms, we can plug in the values and calculate the current.

$I = \sqrt{40 / 3.2} = 3.16228 \hat{=} 3.16$ amps

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<answer> A </answer>